

*"More durable policy solutions to mass unemployment than UBI"*

There are several issues linked to massive unemployment, which are interconnected and must be resolved together to cope with this challenge. UBI would provide basic sustenance to a population, without encouraging activity, nor solving other problems. It is a quick fix that cannot hold on the long-term, a government would also need to find resources to keep providing to the people. Similarly, vast reskilling programs would put a strain on government resources and people might ultimately remain unemployed if the demand for labour is low. The core difficulty is seeing capitalist labour as the main way to contribute to society, and reciprocally to maintain oneself. A change in culture and approach needs to be found in the shape of alternatives to direct salaried work.

The core of the research would be a qualitative exploration of possibilities. The first steps would consist in considering how past "economic" systems could translate into a high-tech world. For instance, bartering, informal work, or a framework rewarding stewardship, such as community building, environmental care and civic engagement are support from different levels of government or independent institutions. Secondly, the creation or saving of energy and data could be translated into currency to constitute additional revenue. Lastly, given the extended time people would have, more social value would be put in personal development. Thus, the practice or pursuit of arts, sports, games, but also the longer engagement with education (for the sake of knowledge rather than a means to becoming employed) would provide people with intrinsic goals.

The question is: How could challenges raised by AI-triggered massive unemployment be sustainably resolved? My contribution would be the production of alternative models that could address at the same time: individual sustenance, continued action to solve social problems or improve community life and finding occupations to remain active. When relevant, I will undertake scenario-writing with quantitative modelling to forecast the needs for alternatives to employments and their incremental implementation, based on the population share without activity. Based on defined sustainability criteria, different simulations of future with ubiquitous AI presence will serve as comparative study cases across new economic models, but also countries.

Beyond the expected written outputs, my objective is to create a conceptual framework highlighting the needs and interests of the stakeholders and how they would be addressed under the alternative solutions. The unresolved questions would be concerning criminality or abuses of the system, but the unavailability of real-life experiment or reliable data on historical examples limit their exploration. Additionally, government or institutions providing goods would still lack adequate revenue.